वैदिकरूपस्य प्रयोजनम् (The Nature and Purpose of the Vēda)

Abstract
This study explores the Vēdic conception of phonetic energy as a manifestation of cosmic and divine principles. Among the five primary foundations - Prāṇa (vital energy), Bala (strength), Yajña, Kāla (time), and Akṣara (Vēdāksharās), each operates through *svara* (intonation), revealing graded levels of consciousness and existence. The *Kṛṣṇa* and *Śukla Yajur Vēda* employ differing tonal structures, symbolizing varying degrees of creative expression. Phonemes such as य*,* र*,* ल*,* व embody states of divine awareness, while consonantal groups represent the physical, imaginative, and intellectual planes of reality. The sounds श*,* ष*,* स*, and* ह correspond to the realm of vital energy, emphasizing the preservation and movement of *prāṇa*. Dēvatās like Mitra, Varuṇa, Aryaman, Bṛhaspati, and Viṣṇu are interpreted as dynamic forces governing speech, meaning, and vitality, illustrating how the Vēdic science of sound integrates metaphysics, linguistics, and cosmology.

Introduction
The life of all beings perpetually exists within three spheres - the realm of action (*Kriyā-loka*), the realm of imagination (*Ūhā-loka*), and the realm of knowledge (*Jñāna-loka*).
The sacred Vēdāksharās (*akṣaras*) that describe the divine energies (*dēvatā-śaktis*) are the *ṛks* (Rig-Mantras). The Vēdāksharās that prescribe the Yajna rituals through which these powers are invoked and utilized are the *yajus* (Yajur -mantras). The Vēdāksharās that elucidate the Supreme Consciousness -the ultimate cause of creation are the *sāmas* (Sāma-Mantras).
The *Sāmas*, composed as musical chants, forest Mantras (*Āraṇyakas*), and *stobhas* (musical refrains), serve to turn the mind toward the contemplation of Brahman. All these- *ṛk*, *yajus*, and *sāma* together constitute the sacred Vēdic Vēdāksharās, the *Saṁhitā-akṣaras*.
At any given moment within these three realms, one predominates while the others recede into the background. The Vēda, therefore, is the self-manifested *Akṣara-Brahman*, the eternal sound principle that emerges to refine and elevate the mode of life of all beings.
The Vēda assigns tonal value (*svara*) to each Vēdākshara, ensuring that the remembrance of the divine is maintained perpetually across all realms. These Vēdic Vēdāksharās are divided according to the cosmic perspective of the three worlds. The *udātta* Vēdākshara represents the higher world, the *svarita* denotes the intermediary state, and the *anudātta* indicates the lower world, together corresponding to the three planes of existence.
In the *Svādhyāya-Yajña* (Yajna of self-recitation), the Vēda instructs which realm must be contemplated at which point in the ritual. Thus, the Vēdic mantra-Vēdāksharās, composed in three tonal forms, manifest as triadic groups of sound that mirror the three worlds.
The *Taittirīya Āraṇyaka* describes these realms themselves as *lokas* (worlds):
"त्रया इमे लोकाः -**Traya ime lokāḥ**" - "These three indeed are the worlds."
Furthermore, it declares that the *Yajña*, the ritual of action is the means for the expansion and enrichment of these three realms. Hence, according to the *Taittirīya Āraṇyaka*, there are two fundamental aspects: the *three worlds* and the *Yajña* that sustains and enlarges them.
Finally, it is affirmed that in any act or undertaking, the *Prāṇa*, the vital consciousness or animating energy is indispensable, for consciousness itself is movement (*kriya*). Therefore, no action can be accomplished without the presence of *Prāṇa*, the principle of life and dynamism that pervades all realms.
Prāṇa denotes consciousness, and consciousness signifies motion. The term *yajña* (Yajna) is synonymous with *karma*, the performance of purposeful action. Yajña is thus intimately related to *prāṇa*, for the vital energy sustains all action. Yet to perform a yajña, not only prāṇa but also *bala* (strength) is required. Strength signifies *śakti*, the dynamic power that may either be innate, accompanying one since birth, or acquired later through effort.
These vital energies, together with the perspectives of the three worlds, constitute five interrelated cycles. The *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (1.3.3) and *Taittirīya Āraṇyaka* (5.2; 5.7) declare: *"Pañkho yajñaḥ"* - "Yajña is of

fivefold form." The number five (*pañkha*) here denotes that all Yajna acts performed by living beings are syntheses of these five principles. The Vēdic *saṃhitās* are divided into sections called *adhikaraṇas*.
In order to render a yajña more efficacious, the Vēda prescribes *svādhyāya-yajña* - the discipline of sacred recitation and study. The great yajña that manifests as the process of life, previously seen through the threefold vision of the worlds, is now to be comprehended from five perspectives. *Svādhyāya* fortifies these five *adhikaraṇas*, thereby enhancing the fruitfulness of daily Yajna living. Since the Vēdic mantras are themselves expositions of cosmic creation, through the practice of *svādhyāya* the structural order (*vyūha*) of this world becomes clear.
Among the five *adhikaraṇas*, the foremost are *prāṇa* (vital force), *bala* (strength), *yajña* (Yajna), *kāla* (time), and *akṣara* (the sacred Vēdāksharās). All of these exist inherently through *svara*, the tonal vibration of sound. The mantras of the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda* reveal the creative principle of existence and are thus expressed through three tones (*trisvara*). Those very mantras, when adapted for use in *svādhyāya-yajña*, become the *Śukla Yajur Vēda*, characterized by five tones (*pañcasvara*).
The supreme consciousness, *Brahman* is the eternal principle that performs all cosmic functions at all times. Brahman manifests as the integration of numerous *dēvatā-śaktis* (divine energies), each governing a specific creative process. Human life itself is a great yajña. Within this cosmic Yajna, each Dēvatā assists distinct aspirations and endeavors. The knowledge of these divine functions and their relationships is designated as *Kṛṣṇa*, and the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda* serves as the means for attaining this understanding.
Every human being, by employing these mantras in their own acts of yajña, invokes the influence of the corresponding dēvatās and thereby attains the desired fruit of Yajna. The term *Śukla* signifies the exalted or luminous accomplishment of this process, while *Kṛṣṇa* does not mean "black," nor *Śukla* merely "white." The profound Vēdic terms should not be reduced to their ordinary, worldly Sanskrit meanings, for they embody metaphysical significance.
When the form of *Brahman* is realized, the Vēdic Vēdāksharās bearing three tones in the mantras of yajña are adorned with five tons of radiance. The unification of these five forms of *adhikaraṇa* within the Yajna act reflects the characteristic power of *Indra-śakti*. As declared, *"Sarve indrā bhavanti"* - "All become Indra." The *RigVēda* contains thousands of Mantras concerning Indra, and in the *Sāma Vēda*, the *Pūrvārcika* includes an *Indra-kāṇḍa* explicitly devoted to this theme.
The formation of *yajna*, its assumption of structure or *āyatana* is accomplished through specific supportive principles that the Vēda names *daśāḥ* (stages or extensions). The energy that unites these seven stages to give form and stability to the yajña is called *Prajāpati*. Hence, *"Śabda-daśaḥ prajāpatiḥ"* - "Prajāpati is the tenfold manifestation of sound." Because the entire creation arises as the *āyatana* (embodied form) of yajña, the Vēda frequently employs the term *Prajāpati* in its mantras.
Āyatana means "form" or "locus", that which is conceived in the mind as an image or perceived by the eyes as a manifest form. Thus, the structure of existence itself is an outcome of the Yajna order sustained by consciousness, sound, and divine energy.
The form perceived through the auditory organ (*śravaṇendriya*) constitutes one type of *āyatana* (manifest form). Together with the visible form, these two constitute the collective manifestation of *āyatanas*. Within these, there exist distinct aspects known as *saṃjñāna* (awareness), *vijñāna* (discernment), and *prajñāna* (higher knowledge). These are integral divisions within the structure of *āyatana*, and their operation is referred to as *yajña* or *dēva-karma* (divine action).
As declared in the *Taittirīya Saṃhitā* (1.1.3):
"Śundhadhvam daivyayā karmaṇe dēva yajyāyai."
This mantra signifies that purity must be attained for the performance of divine action (*dēva-karma*). In any undertaking, that is, in every act of yajna, it is the senses (*indriyas*) that impart shape and form to the *āyatana*. Among these, the auditory organ (*śravaṇendriya*) performs a vital role in the *adhyayana-yajña* (Yajna act of study), in conjunction with the mind (*manas*).
Here, the *śravaṇendriya* denotes the faculty of hearing that becomes refined through Vēdic study. Since Vēdic speech (*Vēda-vāk*) leads to *Brahma-jñāna* (realization of the Absolute), the auditory organ, when disciplined through *adhyayana*, gradually unites with *saṃjñāna*. This process of study itself constitutes a yajña that proceeds through several stages (*daśās*). When the manifestation of Brahman as *āyatana* occurs, the Vēdic mantras become differentiated into tonal sequences, where each *daśā* corresponds to one *svara* (intonation). This tonal formation represents the very essence of the Vēda.

The *akṣaras* (Vēdākshara sounds) are indispensable to the purpose of the Vēda. Through them, and through the Vēda itself, living beings attain the intended fruits of existence. The articulation of the Vēda and its mantras is made possible by the *vāk-yantra*, the mechanism of speech within which the Vēdāksharās are organized into five groups. Just as living beings subsist through five *prāṇas*, the dynamics of life correspond to these fivefold groups of sound. Here, *prāṇa* signifies movement (*sanchalana*), and movement denotes the manner of activity or interaction.
Living beings traverse five planes of existence (*lokas*). The *Taittirīya Upaniṣad* (7th Anuvāka) declares:
"Prāṇo vyāno udāno apānaḥ samānaḥ prāktaṃ vā idaṃ sarvam."

That is, the five vital airs - *prāṇa*, *vyāna*, *udāna*, *apāna*, and *samāna* operate within the individual. Consequently, all human activity functions through these five modalities.
Within the five groups of Vēdāksharās, the final group य, र, ल, व holds particular significance. In the Vēda, the Vēdākshara य denotes *yatna* (effort), र signifies the *jīva* (living being), and ल refers to the existential state or condition in which the being abides, whether of emotion, aspiration, or divine realization. Each of these य, र, ल, व embodies distinct *śaktis* (powers). The Vēdākshara व represents *vāk* (speech), an inherent faculty of every human being. Yet, though common in essence, this characteristic manifests uniquely in each individual. A being's effort (य), its divine disposition (ल), its state of existence (र), and its speech (व) are all its own expressions of life. Hence, the final set of Vēdāksharās य, र, ल, व is specially embedded within the human vocal system.
The second set of Vēdāksharās श, ष, स, ह pertains to the *prāṇa-loka* (realm of vital energy). The र-*kāra* corresponds to the individual's life-force, while श-*kāra* represents the *prāṇa* of the divine energy. The ष-*kāra* embodies the protection and stability of *prāṇa*. Indeed, the security of the life-force is indispensable, for well-being (*sukha*), peace (*śānti*), and safety (*bhadrata*) are all Vēdic concepts arising from the same root of divine order. The great *Brāhmaṇa* texts of the Vēda transform these concepts into expressions of sacred speech (*vāk-rūpa*).
The third perspective is revealed through the groups क, च, ट, त, प Vēdāksharās that express the operations of the physical realm. Their counterparts ग, ज, ड, द, ब convey the activities of the imaginative or mental plane. The nasal consonants ङ, ञ, ण, न, म, which are the fifth Vēdāksharās of each series, signify the dimension of knowledge (*jñāna-loka*), rendering the realm of cognition perceptible.
The *Śānti Mantra* proclaims:
"Śaṃ no Mitraḥ śaṃ Varuṇaḥ
Śaṃ no bhavatu Aryamā
Śaṃ na Indro Bṛhaspatiḥ
Śaṃ no Viṣṇur urukramaḥ."
This is the celebrated *Mantra of Peace*. When the Vāk (speech) assumes manifest form, the divine powers Mitra, Varuṇa, Aryamān, Indra, Bṛhaspati, and Viṣṇu become its presiding dēvatās. The relationship between speech and these dēvatās must be understood through the perspective of the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*).
Mitra represents the life-sustaining vital power underlying speech, the *prāṇa-vyāpāra-śakti*. Varuṇa signifies the energy that brings speech outward into expression. Aryamān embodies the faculty that perceives the meaningful function (*artha-prayojana*) of the Vēdākshara. Bṛhaspati personifies the very form of speech, the *ākāra* or *āyatana* of the Vēdākshara. Viṣṇu, as *Urukrama*, is the expansive power that links one Vēdākshara with another, propelling sound forward in rhythmic sequence. Since ष -*kāra* represents the protection of life, the *Mitra-śakti*, the vital expansive power of prāṇa is regarded as the foremost among these divine forces.

Discussion
Among the five principal foundations, *Prāṇa* (vital energy), *Bala* (strength), *Yajña* (Yajna), *Kāla* (time), and *Akṣara* (the imperishable Vēdāksharās) are regarded as fundamental. All these exist in association with *svara* (intonation or accent).

The mantras of the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda* elucidate the nature of cosmic creation and are therefore composed with three *svaras*. The *Śukla Yajur Vēda*, whose mantras are employed in *svādhyāya-yajñas* (Yajna recitations undertaken as acts of self-study and internal worship), incorporates five *svaras*, reflecting a more comprehensive manifestation of sound and consciousness [Method-1, Ref (1)].
The *Udātta* accent of the Vēdākshara signifies the principal realm (*loka*). The *Svarita* Vēdākshara represents the intermediate or succeeding state that follows it. The *Anudātta* Vēdākshara denotes the final or lower realm in this sequence. These three intonations thus correspond to the three worlds (*triloka*). The Vēda further instructs, within the context of *Svādhyāya Yajña* (the Yajna act of sacred recitation and contemplation), at what specific moment one must meditate upon each respective realm [Method-2, Ref (2)].
When one is in a state of heightened emotion, intense feeling, or divine consciousness (*dēvatā sthiti*), the corresponding states are represented by the phonetic elements *ya*, *ra*, *la*, and *va*. These are the inherent powers (*śakti-s*) of the Vēdāksharās (*akṣara-s*).
Every living being possesses two primary states. The phoneme *va-kāra* relates to *vāk* (speech) and signifies the natural attribute common to all human beings. However, this attribute manifests uniquely within each individual. The effort (*prayatna*), divine condition (*dēvatā sthiti*), the *la-kāra*, and the *vāk* of each being are distinctive to that particular being [Method-3, Ref (3)].
The third level of perception (*dṛṣṭi*) is represented by the five consonants *ka, ca, ṭa, ta,* and *pa*, which denote the sphere of physical activity, the realm of material action (*kriyā-loka*). The following five consonants *ga, ja, ḍa, da,* and *ba* articulate the functions of the imaginative realm (*ūhā-loka*). The fifth Vēdāksharās of these groups *ṅa, ña, ṇa, na,* and *ma* are the nasalized consonants (*anunāsika akṣara-s*), and they render perceptible the domain of knowledge (*jñāna-loka*).
Thus, these phonetic groupings symbolically correspond to three progressive planes of existence: the physical, the imaginative, and the intellectual, revealing how the *Vēdic* phonemes encode ontological gradations within consciousness [Method-4, Ref (4)].
In the second section, the four phonemes श, ष, स, *and* ह are related to the *Prāṇa-loka*, the realm of vital energy. The *ra-kāra* (the sound “ra”) represents the life-force (*prāṇa*) of the individual being. The *śa-kāra* signifies the life-energy of the divine power (*dēvatā-śakti*), indicating the movement of the supreme force within us. The *ṣa-kāra* denotes the protection or preservation of that vital energy. For every living being, the security of life-force is of utmost importance. Notably, the terms *sukha* (happiness), *śānti* (peace), and *bhadrata* (safety) themselves originate from *Vēdic* expressions that signify states sustained by this vital energy [Method-5, Ref (5)].
The Dēvatā *Mitra* represents the vital operative energy (*prāṇa-vyāpāra-śakti*) that serves as the life-source of speech, that is, of the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*). *Varuṇa* embodies the power that brings forth speech into external expression. *Aryaman* signifies the faculty that perceives the meaning and utility (*artha-prayojana*) of each Vēdākshara. *Bṛhaspati* is the manifest form of speech itself, the structural embodiment (*āyatana-svarūpa*) of the Vēdākshara. *Viṣṇu* is identified as *Urukrama*, the dynamic force that moves a Vēdākshara forward by linking it with another. The phoneme *ṣa-kāra*, associated with the preservation of vital energy (*prāṇa-bhadrata*), therefore corresponds primarily to the operative power of *Mitra*, who governs the vital movement of speech [Method-6, Ref (6)].

Methods
Method-1:
RigVēda (1-164-48)

- देवता संवत्सरात्मा कालः
- ऋषिः दीर्घतमाः
- छन्दः स्वराट्पङ्क्तिः
- स्वरः पञ्चमः

द्वादश प्रधयश्चक्रमेकं त्रीणि नभ्यानि क उ तच्चिकेत । तस्मिन्त्साकं त्रिशता न शङ्कवोऽर्पिताः षष्टिर्न चलाचलासः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-164-48):

The **twelve spokes of the wheel**, which are firmly joined, represent the **twelve months**.
This **wheel** symbolizes **time (kāla-cakra)**, and it possesses **three hubs**.
The blissful Lord, **Mahādeva**, contemplated upon that is, **brought into being** this wheel of time.
Within it are contained **three hundred** elements (days) resembling revolutions or turns, and each day into **sixty** divisions (24 minutes each division called as "घटिक" - Ghatika), both **moving and unmoving**, which are offered or dedicated within this cosmic order.

Proposition:

- **Question:** What is meant by "the twelve firmly conjoined spokes of the wheel"?
  Answer: Since the Dēvatā of this mantra is *Saṁvatsarātmā Kālaḥ*, Time in the form of the Year, these twelve spokes signify the **twelve syllabic conjunctions or months** that constitute the divisions of time.
- **Question:** In this mantra, what do the "three hubs" represent?
  Answer: The three hubs correspond to the **three accents**- *udātta*, *anudātta*, and *svarita*; or, alternatively, to the **three seasons** - *vasanta* (spring), *grīṣma* (summer), and *śarad* (autumn). They may also be interpreted as the **three worlds** - *Sūrya* (solar), *Candra* (lunar), and *Agni* (terrestrial or fiery).
- **Question:** Who is referred to as the "embodiment of bliss" (*sukhasvarūpa*)?
  Answer: The "embodiment of bliss" is **Mahādeva**, who grants felicity within the **three worlds**, through the **three accents**, and throughout all **days and years** of the cosmic cycle.

Conclusion of Method-1:
This mantra symbolically reveals the **cosmic wheel of Time (Kālacakra)** as both a linguistic and metaphysical principle. The **twelve spokes** signify the progression of months and the continuity of creation, while the **three hubs** expressed as accents, seasons, or worlds indicate the harmonious balance sustaining the universe. Within this wheel, **Mahādeva**, the embodiment of bliss, is portrayed as the divine consciousness who recalls and regulates the movement of Time itself, ensuring the perpetual rhythm of order (*ṛta*) and existence.
Among the five principal foundations - **Prāṇa (vital energy), Bala (strength), Yajña (sacrifice), Kāla (time), and Akṣara (the imperishable Vēdākshara)** each is inherently associated with **svara (intonation or accent)**.
The mantras of the **Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda** elucidate the nature of **cosmic creation**; therefore, they are composed with **three svaras**.
The **Śukla Yajur Vēda**, whose mantras are employed in **Svādhyāya Yajña (the sacrificial act of self-recitation)**, incorporates **five svaras**.
This distinction is affirmed through the **RigVēda (1.164.48)** mantra, which expounds upon the intrinsic relationship between sound, creation, and the sacred accents.

Method-2:
Yajur Vēda (1-6)

- देवता प्रजापतिर्देवता
- ऋषि: परमेष्ठी प्रजापतिर्ऋषिः
- छन्द: आर्ची पङ्क्तिः
- स्वर: पञ्चमः

कस्त्वा॑ युनक्ति॒ स त्वा॑ युनक्ति॒ कस्मै॑ त्वा युनक्ति॒ तस्मै॑ त्वा युनक्ति। कर्म॑णे वां॒ वेषा॑य वाम् ॥६॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (1-6):
He who commands **you** (the first person)
is the same who commands **you** (the second person as well).
For whose sake He commands **you** (the first person),
for that very one He commands **you** (the second person).

For the performance of action (*karma*),
and for the assumption of form or role (*veṣa*),
He commands both of you alike.

Proposition:

- **Question:** In this mantra, who is referred to by the term *"he who"*?
  Answer: The Dēvatā of this mantra is **Prajāpati**. It is he who is being addressed as *"he who"* in the mantra.
- **Question:** In this mantra, who is the first person commanded by Prajāpati?
  Answer: The **Brāhmaṇa** is the first person whom Prajāpati commands.
- **Question:** In this mantra, who is the second person commanded by Prajāpati?
  Answer: The **Kṣatriya** is the second person whom Prajāpati commands.
- **Question:** What does Prajāpati command both of them to do?
  Answer: He commands them to perform their respective **karmas (duties)** and to uphold their **dharma (righteous conduct)**.
- **Question:** How is it known that the first person is the Brāhmaṇa and the second person is the Kṣatriya?
  Answer: The first occurrence of *"tvā"* is in the **svarita** accent, and the second *"tvā"* is in the **udātta** accent.
- Hence, the first person is considered **primary**, while the second person, being subordinate or following, represents **support or accompaniment**. Therefore, the first person signifies the **Brāhmaṇa**, and the second person signifies the **Kṣatriya**.

Conclusion of Method-2:
The **udātta** accent of a Vēdākshara denotes the **primary or higher world**;
the **svarita** accent indicates the **intermediate or supporting realm** that follows it;
and the **anudātta** accent signifies the **lowest or final world** in the sequence.
These three - *udātta, svarita,* and *anudātta* correspond to the **three worlds**.
The Vēda, through the practice of **svādhyāya-yajña** (the sacrificial act of self-recitation and study), also prescribes **which world is to be meditated upon at which moment** during recitation.

Method-3:
RigVēda (1-15-12)

- देवता अग्निः
- ऋषिः मेधातिथिः काण्वः
- छन्दः निचृद्गायत्री
- स्वरः षड्जः

गार्हपत्येन सन्त्य ऋतुना यज्ञनीरसि । देवान्देवयते यज॥१२॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-15-12):
With the Gārhapatya fire and in conjunction with the seasons, you are the one who conducts the yajna.
Perform the yajna, gladden the dēvatās who offer abundant gifts.

Proposition:

- **Question:** With what is the yajña conducted?
  Answer: The yajña is conducted with the Gārhapatya fire and in conjunction with the seasons.
- **Question:** Who is described as the one who conducts the yajña?
  Answer: The addressed individual or Dēvatā is described as the one who conducts the yajña.

- **Question:** What is the command or exhortation given in the passage?
  Answer: The exhortation is to perform the yajña and to gladden the Dēvatās.
- **Question:** Who are to be gladdened through the yajña?
  Answer: The *dēvatās* who bestow abundant gifts are to be gladdened.
- **Question:** Which fire conducts the yajña?
  Answer: The Gārhapatya fire.
- **Question:** In this yajña, what is the effort indicated by the Vēdākshara "य"?
  Answer: The effort implied by "य" is the conducting of the yajña through the Gārhapatya fire. It signifies attaining the state of the Dēvatās, granting the seasons, and bestowing rewards.
- **Question:** Who are those that gladden the Dēvatās?
  Answer: The yajña performed with the Gārhapatya fire gladdens the Dēvatās.
- **Question:** What do the Vēdāksharas य, र, ल, व in the mantra represent?
  Answer: The Vēdāksharas य, र, ल, व in the mantra represent the powers inherent in the sacred Vēdāksharas (*akṣara-śakti*).
- **Question:** What is attained through the Gārhapatya fire and the contemplation of the *akṣara-śaktis*?
  Answer: The yajña performed with the Gārhapatya fire and with meditation on the powers of the sacred Vēdāksharas attains the state of the Dēvatās.
- **Question:** What is the name of the fire that is maintained daily (*nityāgni*)?
  Answer: The Gārhapatya fire.

Conclusion of Method-3:
It is thus understood that in our states of emotional intensity, exaltation, or divine consciousness, the four elements य, र, ल, व represent the corresponding conditions. These are the inherent powers (*śakti-s*) of the Vēdāksharas (*akṣaras*).
Every living being possesses two fundamental states. The element *va-kāra* is associated with *vāk* (speech), which is a natural characteristic of every human being. This characteristic manifests distinctly and uniquely in each individual being.
The effort (*prayatna*) of a being belongs to that being alone; its divine state (*devatā-sthiti*) belongs to it alone; its *la-kāra* (principle of manifestation) is its own; and its *vāk* (speech-expression) too is its own.
This subject of inquiry has been examined and established with the support of the *RigVēda* (1-15-12) mantra.

Method-4:
RigVēda (3-13-3)
- देवता इन्द्राग्नी
- ऋषिः - विश्वामित्रः
- छन्दः - निचृदनुष्टुप्
- स्वरः - गान्धारः

स य॒न्ता विप्र॑ एषां॒ स य॒ज्ञाना॒मथा॒ हि षः । अ॒ग्निं तं वो॑ दु॒वस्यत॒ दाता॒ यो वनि॑ता म॒घम्॥३॥

Essence of RigVēda (3-13-3):
He (Agni) is indeed the origin and commencement of all *yajñas*.
The one who offers these *yajñas* , the donor or *yajñas* (*yajamāna*) is Indra, your guide and leader.
The one who sows or establishes *dharma* (the righteous order), the *vipra* (wise priest), ought to serve Agni with devotion.
That *vipra* is entitled to seek from the *yajamāna* the most abundant wealth as his due offering.

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who is the Dēvatā of this mantra?
  Answer: Indra-Agni and the earthly fire (*Vidyut-Pārthiva Agni*) are the Dēvatās of this mantra.
- **Question:** Which nasal consonants (*anunāsika akṣaras*) are mentioned in this study?
  Answer: ङ, ञ, ण, न, म
- **Question:** Why are these Vēdāksharas called nasal consonants (*anunāsika akṣaras*)?
  Answer: Because the place of articulation for these Vēdāksharas is the nose (*nāsikā*).
- **Question:** How is it determined that these Vēdāksharas are related to the realm of knowledge (*jñānaloka*)?
  Answer: Since the flow of *prāṇa* and *apāna* occurs through the nose, these Vēdāksharas are associated with vital breath and, consequently, with *prāṇāyāma* (control of life force by Indra and Agni).

Conclusion of Method-4:
The combination of **Vidyut Agni** (electric or energetic fire) and **vāyu** (air) gives rise to **prāṇāyāma**, which culminates in the **sacrifice of knowledge (*jñāna-yajña*)**.
Based on the above-mentioned considerations, the **nasal consonants (*anunāsika akṣaras*)** are thus confirmed to be related to knowledge (*jñāna*), providing strong support to this research.

Method-5:
Yajur Vēda (21-10)

- देवता: ऋत्विजो देवताः
- ऋषि: आत्रेय ऋषिः
- छन्द: भुरिक्पङ्क्तिः
- स्वर: पञ्चमः

शन्नो॑ भवन्तु वा॒जिनो॒ हवे॑षु दे॒वता॑ता मि॒तद्र॑वः स्व॒र्काः। ज॒म्भय॒न्तोऽहिं॒ वृक॒□ रक्षां॑□सि॒ सने॑म्य॒स्मद्यु॑यव॒न्नमी॑वाः ॥१० ॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (21-10):
“O you who possess abundant food and wealth! Those who act in accordance with established principles and perform divine service shall, by the power of the mighty or through his command and yajnas, bring about the destruction of serpents, clouds, thieves, and malevolent beings.
May all auspiciousness prevail for us at all times!”
“Drive away from us the worms that generate disease.”

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are being addressed at the beginning of the passage?
  Answer: Those who possess abundant food and wealth are being addressed.
- **Question:** What qualities do the addressed individuals possess?
  Answer: They act in accordance with established principles and perform divine service.
- **Question:** Through whose power or command do they bring about destruction?
  Answer: They act through the power or command of the mighty one and through yajnas.
- **Question:** Whom do they destroy or remove?
  Answer: They bring about the destruction of serpents, clouds, thieves, and malevolent beings.
- **Question:** What is the prayer or wish expressed in the Mantra?
  Answer: The prayer is that all auspiciousness may prevail for us at all times.
- **Question:** What is requested regarding disease-causing worms?
  Answer: It is requested that the worms which generate disease be driven away.

Conclusion of Method-5:
It is demonstrated, with the support of the Yajur Vēda (21–10) mantra, that the terms ***sukha*** (happiness), ***śānti*** (peace), and ***bhadrata*** (security or well-being) are themselves expressions originating from the Vedic vocabulary.

Method-6:
Yajur Vēda (34-55)

- देवता: अध्यात्मं प्राणा देवताः
- ऋषि: कण्व ऋषिः
- छन्द: भुरिग्जगती
- स्वर: निषादः

स॒प्तऽऋष॑य॒: प्रति॑हिता॒: शरी॑रे स॒प्त र॑क्षन्ति॒ सद॒मप्र॑मादम्। स॒प्ताप॒: स्वप॑तो लो॒कमी॑यु॒स्तत्र॑ जागृतो॒ऽअस्व॑प्नजौ सत्र॒सदौ॑ च दे॒वौ ॥५५ ॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (34-55):
The seven Ṛṣis, identified with beneficent forces, perpetually safeguard the seven vital regions within the body.
The seven waters reach the realm of those who sleep; yet, in that state or place, the sources of *prāṇa* (vital breath) and *apāna* (downward breath) remain awake. They serve to protect the noble ones who do not succumb to sleep thus ensuring their well-being (*bhadra*).

Proposition:

- **Question:** Who are said to safeguard the seven regions within the body?
  Answer: The seven Ṛṣis, who are identified with beneficent forces, safeguard the seven regions within the body.
- **Question:** What do the seven Ṛṣis represent in this context?
  Answer: They represent the protective and beneficent principles that constantly guard the human body.
- **Question:** What is said about the seven waters (*sapta jala*)?
  Answer: The seven waters reach or permeate the realm of those who sleep.
- **Question:** What remains awake when others are asleep?
  Answer: The sources of *prāṇa* (vital breath) and *apāna* (downward breath) remain awake even when one sleeps.
- **Question5:** Whom do these awakened forces protect?
  Answer: They protect the noble ones (*satpuruṣas*) who remain wakeful in consciousness and do not fall into ignorance or slumber.
- **Question:** What is the result of this protection?
  Answer: Through their protection, well-being (*bhadra*) and safety are established.
- **Question:** Who is the Dēvatā presiding over the vital energy that governs the functions of *prāṇa* (vital breath) and *apāna* (downward breath)?
  Answer: Mitra is the Dēvatā of the *prāṇa–apāna* vital functions.
- **Question:** Who is the Dēvatā presiding over the manifest power of speech (*vaikharī vāk-śakti*)?
  Answer: Varuṇa is the Dēvatā of the manifest power of speech, associated with the seven waters.

Conclusion of Method-6:
The vital operative power (*prāṇa-vyāpāra-śakti*) is governed by **Mitra**;
the manifest power of speech (*vaikharī vāk-śakti*) by **Varuṇa**;
the power of meaningful purpose (*artha-prayojana-śakti*) by **Aryaman**;

the principle of the inner abode or foundation (*āyatana-svarūpa*) by **Bṛhaspati**;
the power of expansive progression (*urukrama-śakti*) by **Viṣṇu**;
and the protective power of life (*prāṇa-bhadra-śakti*) by the Vēdākshara **"ष -".**
Through the influence of these divine powers, the **seven Ṛṣis**, who protect the noble beings within the body, become manifest. Consequently, the **seven beneficent forces (hitas)**, corresponding to the **seven waters**, perpetually safeguard the being.
The sources of *prāṇa* and *apāna* remain ever awake, guarding both the realm of those who sleep and the well-being (*bhadra*) of those who remain wakeful.

Conclusion

This exposition elucidates the intricate relationship between sound, consciousness, and creation within the Vēdic framework. The five fundamental principles- *Prāṇa*, *Bala*, *Yajña*, *Kāla*, and *Akṣara* operate through *svara*, the intonational force that animates the Vēdākshara and sustains cosmic order. Each *svara* and *akṣara* embodies a metaphysical dimension, linking the realms of action (*Kriyā-loka*), imagination (*Ūhā-loka*), and knowledge (*Jñāna-loka*). Through this phonetic symbolism, the Vēda presents speech not merely as communication but as a manifestation of divine energy and consciousness. The functions of dēvatās such as Mitra, Varuṇa, Aryaman, Bṛhaspati, and Viṣṇu demonstrate how *vāk* (speech) serves as a living medium through which the life-force (*prāṇa*) flows and evolves. Thus, *Akṣara,* the imperishable Vēdākshara emerges as the bridge between the human and the cosmic, revealing the unity of language, energy, and spiritual realization.

References

(1). RigVēda (1-164-48)
(2). Yajur Vēda (1-6)
(3). RigVēda (1-15-12)
(4). RigVēda (3-13-3)
(5). Yajur Vēda (21-10)
(6). Yajur Vēda (34-55)